

Rape Cases in India: 2000–2026

Context and Data

Year-Wise Statistics, Political Context, and Judicial Release Information
Source: NCRB Reports

Context & Data Availability

- Data Source: National Crime Records Bureau (NCRB) – 'Crime in India' reports.
- The numbers reflect *registered* cases under Section 376 IPC (and later POCSO).
- An increase in numbers post-2012 points to better reporting and broader legal definitions (following the Nirbhaya case), rather than purely an increase in crime rate.
- Data for 2024–2026: Official consolidated NCRB reports trail by 1–2 years, so exact figures for these years are pending compilation.

NCRB Data: Year-Wise Registered Cases (2000–2026)

** 2013 spike attributed to the Criminal Law (Amendment) Act, 2013*

Year	Cases Registered	Ruling Party	Prime Minister
2000	16,496	NDA (BJP-led)	Atal Bihari Vajpayee
2001	16,075	NDA (BJP-led)	Atal Bihari Vajpayee
2002	16,373	NDA (BJP-led)	Atal Bihari Vajpayee
2003	15,847	NDA (BJP-led)	Atal Bihari Vajpayee
2004	18,233	NDA / UPA (INC-led)	A.B. Vajpayee / Manmohan Singh
2005	18,359	UPA (INC-led)	Manmohan Singh
2006	19,348	UPA (INC-led)	Manmohan Singh
2007	20,737	UPA (INC-led)	Manmohan Singh
2008	21,467	UPA (INC-led)	Manmohan Singh
2009	21,397	UPA (INC-led)	Manmohan Singh
2010	22,172	UPA (INC-led)	Manmohan Singh
2011	24,206	UPA (INC-led)	Manmohan Singh
2012	24,923	UPA (INC-led)	Manmohan Singh
2013	33,707*	UPA (INC-led)	Manmohan Singh
2014	36,735	UPA / NDA (BJP-led)	Manmohan / Narendra Modi
2015	34,651	NDA (BJP-led)	Narendra Modi
2016	38,947	NDA (BJP-led)	Narendra Modi
2017	32,559	NDA (BJP-led)	Narendra Modi
2018	33,356	NDA (BJP-led)	Narendra Modi
2019	32,033	NDA (BJP-led)	Narendra Modi
2020	28,046	NDA (BJP-led)	Narendra Modi
2021	31,677	NDA (BJP-led)	Narendra Modi
2022	31,516	NDA (BJP-led)	Narendra Modi
2023	29,670	NDA (BJP-led)	Narendra Modi

Year	Cases Registered	Ruling Party	Prime Minister
2024	Pending	NDA (BJP-led)	Narendra Modi
2025	Pending	NDA (BJP-led)	Narendra Modi
2026	Pending	NDA (BJP-led)	Narendra Modi

Release of Convicted Accused: Overview

- NCRB does not publish national aggregated statistics specifically on convicted rapists released.
- Overall Conviction Rate: Remains low (22%–28%). Acquittals form the majority due to hostile witnesses, lack of evidence, and delays.
- Prison administration is a 'State Subject'. Premature release decisions are made by State Sentence Review Boards (SSRBs).

Reasons for Release

1. Remission of Sentence (Premature Release)

→ Provided for 'good behavior', finishing 14 years jail term. Example: 11 Bilkis Bano convicts were originally released by Gujarat govt via its 1992 policy (later struck down by the Supreme Court as illegal in 2024).

2. Parole / Furlough

→ Temporary release for medical/family emergencies or societal ties. Example: High-profile cases like Gurmeet Ram Rahim receiving recurrent parole, which sometimes sparks political debate.

3. Completion of Standard Term

→ For cases without life imprisonment, standard terms are finished routinely.